Bard Information Technology - dbrangaitis@bard.edu
Bard Public Relations - pr@bard.edu
Revised 02/26/2025
- Added Cloudflare origin cert option
- Added IT/PR review process

Bard web application and hosting requirements

Bard IT Web Services offers two environments for websites related to Bard efforts:

1. **Custom Bard CMS**
    a. Within www.bard.edu/[x] hierarchy
    b. A subdomain such as [x].bard.edu

2. **Shared Wordpress instance**
    a. Within blogs.bard.edu/[x] hierarchy
    b. A subdomain such as [x].bard.edu

Both options impose sensible restrictions on what can be customized. Internal website managers and/or external developers must work within these environments as provided. For example, Wordpress plugins must be picked from a set that have been previously vetted, and Custom CMS templates must be designed by Web Services.

If a website is to be developed by a third party or otherwise would not fit into the environments outlined above, it will be necessary to use external hosting. Bard IT will not offer support for this website or environment except as detailed below.

This document will outline the institutional requirements for such projects and may be shared with external vendors.

Relevant contacts

David Brangaitis, dbrangaitis@bard.edu - Bard CIO and maintainer of this document
Bard Web Services, webservices@bard.edu
Bard Public Relations, pr@bard.edu
Bard IT Helpdesk, helpdesk@bard.edu - Technical requests: DNS, Email, etc.
Information Stewardship Council, isc@bard.edu - Vetting for new vendors and systems, security guidelines

Specific requirements

Vetting and upkeep

The developer company and/or hosting environment must be made known to Bard IT and Bard PR before a contract is signed. These offices will help guide the project with relevant information security and vendor management procedures and ensure adherence to the other requirements outlined in this document.

A development copy of the website must be made available to Bard IT and PR for security and accessibility assessment prior to go-live.

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In addition:

- An active service contract must be maintained throughout the life of the project. This contract must include server and application security updates as necessary. Any changes to this contract or associated contacts should be sent to Bard IT.
    - If a contract expires, Bard IT can not offer support to migrate or maintain the website.
- Relevant website, application, and server credentials must be maintained by more than one individual associated with a Bard office. An account may be created for Bard IT or Bard PR for additional redundancy.
    - Maintain non-default, long and strong passwords all resources
    - Authentication and access control policy may apply
- Any changes to the contract or hosting environment should be communicated to Bard IT and Bard PR.

Hosting

All sites/domains

- Website should be hosted with a dedicated IPv4 and ideally an IPv6 address. Shared servers are not acceptable in most cases.
- Domain and DNS requirements:
    - DNS must be handled by Bard IT
    - “www” prefix must be used only on top level domains (bard.edu). It must not be used for subdomains (e.g. www.project.bard.edu)
    - Wildcard top level or second level DNS entries (e.g. *.domain.com, *.something.domain.edu) must not be used.
- Website security requirements:
    - Website must force and redirect to HTTPS with modern ciphers and a valid SSL certificate, even during development phases.
        - SSLv3, TLS 1.0, and 1.1 must be disabled, TLS 1.2 or greater required.
        - HSTS web application header should be enabled
        - Free certificate authorities are acceptable (Let’s Encrypt)
        - Cloudflare origin certificates may be issued by Bard IT
    - Web headers should follow current best practices, with at least the following implemented:
        - Content-Security-Policy
        - HTTP Strict-Transport-Security
        - X-Content-Type-Options
        - Cache-Control
- Server requirements:
    - Modern and fully updated server or platform
    - No unnecessary ports exposed
    - No unencrypted communication (FTP, Telnet, etc.)
- Applications such as content management systems (e.g., Wordpress) and any plugins must be regularly updated and maintain the latest level of security patches within.

    - Critical patches must be applied within 24 hours
    - Noncritical patches or other updates must be applied within two months of release

Bard.edu subdomains

- Website should operate behind bard.edu Cloudflare proxy and ideally restrict external web access to only Cloudflare and, if needed, Bard.edu Annandale campus ranges (private).

Non-bard.edu domains

- **Non-bard.edu domains (e.g. [x].org/.com) should generally not be used.**
- Non-bard.edu domains that are used for unsanctioned business such as personal projects, blogs, or other efforts must not use “Bard College” anywhere in the registration and may avoid all requirements in this document, though security guidelines should be followed.
- If a non-bard.edu domain is desired for official and sanctioned Bard business, an exception may be granted by Bard PR/IT. This may not apply to subdomains created for a specific service (e.g. bard.zoom.us).
    - Domain and DNS must be owned and managed by Bard IT
    - Site should operate behind Cloudflare web proxy
    - To support HSTS, http connections to the domain (e.g. http://[x].com) should immediately redirect to https://[x].com and then add the www subdomain if desired
    - HSTS with all subdomains and preload must be enabled.
        - Strict-Transport-Security: max-age=31536000; includeSubDomains; preload

Email

- The website or application should not generate email using a bard.edu email address. If this is necessary, Bard IT will provide dedicated SMTP credentials for a single sender. Applications with significant email requirements may be considered for inclusion in DNS-based email security mechanisms, SPF and DKIM.
- The website or application must not generate bulk emails or emails that could be categorized as spam.
- The website or application must not directly accept incoming emails (no MX records will be published).

Branding and Presentation

These branding and presentation requirements may not apply to all efforts, especially academic projects. Bard PR will advise.

- The Bard logo (in Bard red, white, black, or gray) should be present in the header and/or footer (preferably both) and accompanied by a link back to https://www.bard.edu.
- Consult with the Web Services Office ahead of any logo design for your program’s website or social media presence.
- The Bard logo and additional branding suggestions can be found at: https://www.bard.edu/communications/branding.

- As much as possible, try to keep design and layout consistent with Bard's current "look and feel." To best accomplish this, coordinate with Bard Public Relations while planning any website redesign, as plans for presentation and branding improvements may be underway.
- Prior to website launch, please circulate the proposed website to the Bard PR and Web Services Offices for review.
- Please consult with Bard PR regarding any related social media accounts. The PR Office can advise on branding, institutional voice, and other best practices, and should also receive all social media login credentials to ensure account continuity.

Content compliance

Website forms

- All web forms must use CAPTCHA or other related technologies to prevent spam.
- Forms must not collect sensitive or personally identifiable data including: SSN, birthday, license numbers, credit card information, etc.

Media

- Ensure that any and all imagery and video on the site are owned by Bard College or reside in the public domain, or that you have obtained proper permission for their use. Credit photographers and include class year for student and alumni/ae photographers.
- Do not use photographs or video of minors without express permission from parents or guardians.
- Please see the College's photo and video policy here: https://www.bard.edu/communications/photography/

News and Events

- Coordinate with Web Services and PR to assure that the program's news and events are centralized through Bard's tools.

Regulatory compliance

- **WCA Compliance:** Website content must meet the accessibility requirements as outlined by the **WCAG 2/3** (Web Content Accessibility Guidelines) and pass Web Accessibility Checkers such as **WAVE by WebAim**.
- **Cookie Consent:** As a result of **CCPA** (California) and **GDPR** (EU), it is commonly accepted (and required by the EU) that websites will employ the use of Cookie Consent software that will allow users determine how the website and its third-party vendors will use their personal identifiable information (PII).
- **Website privacy policy** - Bard College is still drafting a central version of a privacy policy, but it will be required in the future and may differ for each site.

https://www.ietf.org/rfc/rfc2119.txt